

ID: ESC-003 Category: Escalation Audience: IT Staff

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Major Incident Communication Plan

Purpose

Define the communication roles, channels, cadence, and templates used during a Robotix IT P1 Major Incident. This plan works in conjunction with the technical response process in RUN-007. The goal is to ensure that stakeholders receive timely, accurate, consistent updates while the technical team focuses on resolution - without becoming a communication bottleneck.

Guiding Principles

1. Communicate early, even if you don't have answers. Silence is worse than "we are investigating."
2. One source of truth. All updates go through the Communications Lead. Technical staff do not communicate directly to stakeholders during a P1 unless explicitly directed by the IC.
3. Status page is authoritative for users. Direct users to <https://status.robotix.com> rather than providing piecemeal updates.
4. Accuracy over speed for root cause. Provide a preliminary root cause only when confirmed. Do not speculate in external communications.

Roles and Responsibilities

Role

Filled By

Responsibilities

Incident Commander (IC)

L2 Lead or L3 On-Call Engineer

Communications Lead

Designated L2 or Senior L1 on the bridge call

Technical Lead

L3 Engineer

Owns the incident; approves all significant communications; makes go/no-go decisions

Drafts and sends all stakeholder communications; updates status page; monitors Slack/email for user questions; reports to IC

Provides factual updates to Communications Lead on investigation status and ETA to fix; does not communicate externally

Scribe

Junior L2 or L1

IT Director

Gretchen Holloway

CISO

Nathan Burkett

Logs all actions, decisions, and timestamps in the INC ticket in real time

Notified at T+15 min; escalation point if IC needs authority for major decisions; manages exec stakeholder comms

Notified immediately for any security-related P1; owns all security-specific external communication

Communication Channels

Channel

Audience

Used For

Slack #it-major-incidents

IT staff

Slack #it-help

All staff

Slack #announcements

All staff

RobotixDesk ticket (INC-#####)

IT staff

Robotix IT Status Page (<https://status.robotix.com>)

All users + external

Email (all-staff or affected group)

All staff / affected group

IT leadership email/phone

CTO, IT Director, VPs

Zoom Bridge

IT incident team

Internal incident bridge; technical updates; team coordination

Awareness of the issue; do not post technical details

Formal user-facing updates (sparingly - do not over-post)

Full incident log; all technical details; timestamped updates

Authoritative service status; updated every 30-60 minutes during incident

For extended outages (>2 hours); do not email for short outages

Direct notification for high-severity incidents

Live coordination during active P1

Vendor support portal

Vendor technical team

Open vendor cases; relay updates to IC

Communication Cadence

Time

T+0

T+5

T+10

T+15

T+15

T+30

T+30

T+60

Every 60 min

Action

Owner

Channel(s)

P1 declared; INC ticket created

First Responder

RobotixDesk

Bridge call opened; team assembled

IC

Slack #it-major-incidents

#it-help awareness post: "We are aware of an issue with [service]. Investigating."

IT leadership notified (IT Director, CTO if warranted)

Status page updated: Investigating

First formal update to IT leadership with preliminary assessment

Status page updated with more detail: identified cause or ongoing investigation note

Second update to IT leadership; Slack #announcements post if outage >1 hour

Ongoing stakeholder updates until resolved

Comms Lead

Slack #it-help

IC / Comms Lead

Direct Slack DM or phone

Comms Lead

status.robotix.com

Comms Lead

Email to IT Director + affected VPs

Comms Lead

status.robotix.com

Comms Lead

Email + Slack #announcements

Comms Lead

Email + status page

Resolution

T+2 biz days

T+5 biz days

Resolution notice - all channels; all-staff post if outage was >2 hours

PIR meeting scheduled

PIR document published in RobotixDesk knowledge base

IC + Comms Lead

All channels below

IC

IC

Calendar invite

RobotixDesk KB

Status Page Management (<https://status.robotix.com>)

Robotix IT uses a hosted status page (StatusPage.io-compatible) to communicate service health.

Updating the Status Page

1. Log into <https://status.robotix.com/admin> with IT admin credentials.

2. Click + New Incident.

3. Fill in: - Incident name: Brief, plain-language title (e.g., "Email service disruption") - Status:

Investigating / Identified / Monitoring / Resolved - Affected components: Select all impacted services (e.g., Email, VPN, Authentication) - Message body: Use templates below

4. Select notification options: Email subscribers and Slack webhook (auto-posts to #status-updates).

5. Click Create Incident.

Updating an Existing Incident

1.

In the status page admin, find the open incident.

2. Click Add Update.

3. Update the status field and add a message.

4. Save and post - subscribers are notified automatically.

Resolving the Incident on the Status Page

1. Add a final update with status Resolved.

2. All affected components return to Operational.

3. Subscribers receive an automated resolution email.

Communication Templates

Template 1: Initial Awareness Post (Slack #it-help - T+10)

[IT NOTICE] We are aware of an issue affecting [service name, e.g., "Microsoft 365 email"]. Our team is actively investigating. We will provide an update as soon as possible.

For urgent assistance: call +1 (800) 555-7866 or email servicedesk@robotix.com. Status updates: <https://status.robotix.com>

- Robotix IT Service Desk

Template 2: Status Page - Investigating (T+15)

Incident name: [Service] disruption - under investigation Status: Investigating Message:

We are currently investigating an issue affecting [service name]. Users may experience [brief impact description, e.g., "inability to send or receive email"]. Our team has been engaged and is actively working to identify the root cause. Next update: [time].

Template 3: IT Leadership Notification Email (T+30)

Subject: [P1 ACTIVE] IT Incident - [Service Name] - INC-[#####]

Team,

We have declared a Priority 1 incident for [service name].

Incident details: - Ticket: INC-[#####] - Start time: [HH:MM ET] - Impact: [Brief description - how many users, what they cannot do] - Status: Investigating / Root cause identified as [X] / Fix in progress

Current assessment: [2-3 sentences on what we know so far - no speculation]

Estimated resolution time: [ETA if known, or "Under investigation - next update at HH:MM"]

Incident Commander: [Name] Bridge call: <https://robotix.zoom.us/j/999001001>

Next update: [HH:MM ET]

- [Comms Lead Name], Robotix IT

Template 4: User-Facing Update (Slack #announcements or Email - T+60+)

[IT UPDATE - HH:MM ET] - INC-[#####]

Service: [Service Name] Status: [Investigating / Root Cause Identified / Monitoring fix] Impact: [Brief plain-language description]

What we know: [1-2 sentences - factual, no speculation] What we're doing: [1 sentence on action being

taken]

Estimated resolution: [ETA or "We will provide an update by HH:MM ET"]

Thank you for your patience. - Robotix IT Service Desk | status.robotix.com

Template 5: Resolution Announcement

Slack #it-help and #announcements:

[RESOLVED - HH:MM ET] - INC-#####

[Service name] has been fully restored as of [HH:MM ET].

Duration: [start time] - [end time] ([X hours Y minutes]) Impact: [Brief description of who was affected]

Root cause: [Concise, non-technical description]

We apologize for the disruption. If you continue to experience issues, please contact us: +1 (800) 555-7866 | servicedesk@robotix.com | Slack: #it-help

A post-incident review will be completed within 5 business days.

- Robotix IT Service Desk

Resolution email to IT leadership:

Subject: [RESOLVED] IT Incident - [Service Name] - INC-#####

Team,

We have resolved the P1 incident affecting [service name].

Resolution summary: - Resolved at: [HH:MM ET] - Total duration: [X hours Y minutes] - Users affected: [estimate] - Root cause: [1-2 sentences - technical but accessible] - Fix applied: [What was done]

A formal Post-Incident Review (PIR) will be scheduled within 2 business days and the PIR document will be published within 5 business days.

Incident Commander: [Name] Ticket: INC-#####

- [Comms Lead Name] on behalf of the Robotix IT team

Stakeholder Contact List

Stakeholder

Role

Notification Trigger

Contact

Gretchen Holloway

IT Director

All P1s - T+15 min

gretchen.holloway@robotix.com / +1 (720) 555-0192

Nathan Burkett

CISO

All security-related P1s - immediately

nathan.burkett@robotix.com / +1 (720) 555-0117

Patricia Vang

CTO

Finance VP

Finance VP

HR Director

HR Director

Legal Counsel

General Counsel

All Staff

Employees

Post-Incident Review (PIR) Process

PIR Meeting Agenda (60 minutes)

Time

0-5 min

5-15 min

15-25 min

25-40 min

40-55 min

55-60 min

P1 affecting >200 users or security breach

Finance systems outage (email, ERP)

HR systems outage; any security breach involving employee data

Security breach with data exposure; regulatory notification

P1 lasting >60 minutes affecting all users

patricia.vang@robotix.com / +1 (720) 555-0188

finance-vp@robotix.com

hr-director@robotix.com

legal@robotix.com

all-staff@robotix.com (use sparingly)

Topic

Welcome; confirm attendees; recap incident timeline

Root cause walkthrough by Technical Lead

What went well

What went wrong / gaps identified

Action items - assign owner and due date for each

Next steps; PIR doc publication date

PIR Document Structure

The PIR document is published as a RobotixDesk knowledge base article tagged Post-Incident Review:

1.

Incident summary (title, date, duration, services affected, user impact)

2. Timeline (minute-by-minute log)

3. Root cause analysis (technical and contributing factors)

4. What went well

5. What went wrong / improvement areas

6. Action items (table: item, owner, due date, status)

7. Appendix: INC ticket link; vendor case numbers; bridge call recording link

Action Item Tracking

All PIR action items must be: - Logged as sub-tasks in the original INC ticket or as new REQ tickets linked to the PIR. - Reviewed at the next monthly IT Operations Review. - Closed or escalated within the agreed due date.

Do's and Don'ts During a P1

Do

Do not

Send regular updates even when there is no new technical progress

Go silent for >60 minutes without an update

Keep user-facing language simple and jargon-free

Use technical details (error codes, system names) in all-staff communications

Direct users to the status page for self-service updates

Tell users to "just wait" without an ETA

Report externally requested ETAs to the IC first

Promise resolution times without IC approval

Notify legal/CISO immediately for any data exposure

Speculate on whether data was exposed without SOC/CISO confirmation

Log all decisions in the RobotixDesk ticket

Communicate resolution before verifying with the Technical Lead

Robotix IT Service Desk · Synthetic knowledge base · This document is fictional sample data.

Robotix Technologies — Internal IT Documentation · Synthetic data, no PII.